

Stop losing money in your messy DMs! 🚨

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 01, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/j6tPAuQaQNw> Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Online fitness coaches don't need more followers — they need better systems. A structured 5-stage DM pipeline using Go High Level prevents leads from slipping through the cracks and enables scale.

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🧠 The Core Mindset Shift: Systems Over Followers 0:00

- Most people believe growing their following is the key to making money online — **this is wrong**
 - The real lever is building systems, not chasing audience size
- Brandon Carter claims to have taught over **15,000 people** how to grow successful online fitness businesses
- He identifies a clear performance gap between his top and average students:
 - Top students: making **\$50,000–\$100,000 per month**
 - Average students: making **\$5,000–\$10,000 per month**
 - The differentiator is not follower count — it's how they manage their leads

📁 The Problem: Messy, Unstructured DMs 0:22

- The common mistake: running your entire business through Instagram DMs with no system, no pipeline, and no strategy
- When a video goes viral, new messages flood in and push existing leads down the inbox
 - Leads you've been actively nurturing get buried and forgotten
 - This results in money "slipping through the cracks"
- This problem is especially costly for smaller accounts — with a small following, every single lead matters and losing even one is significant

🛠️ The Solution: Go High Level + a 5-Stage Pipeline 0:22

- Recommended tool: **Go High Level** (GHL), synced directly to your Instagram account
- GHL allows you to set up automations that automatically sort DMs into defined pipeline stages
- You can also message leads directly from inside Go High Level — no need to go back to Instagram
- Recommended 5-stage pipeline structure:
 - **Stage 1 — New Lead:** freshly arrived, not yet engaged
 - **Stage 2 — Warm Lead:** some interaction has occurred, showing interest
 - **Stage 3 — Booked Call:** lead has scheduled a sales or discovery call
 - **Stage 4 — Follow Up:** call happened or lead went cold; needs follow-up
 - **Stage 5 — Close:** deal is done, converted to a paying client
- This gives every lead "some goddamn structure instead of just your Instagram DMs where it's just some messy"

Scaling With a Team 0:45

- As your business grows, Go High Level supports team-based lead management
 - You can add employees directly to your GHL account
 - Team members can nurture leads and book calls on your behalf — removing you from the process entirely
- Even if you're just starting out, implementing this system now is essential
 - Small accounts cannot afford to waste any leads
 - Building the habit and infrastructure early prepares you for scale

Free Trial Offer 1:07

- Brandon offers a **free 30-day trial** of Go High Level
 - To claim it: comment "GHL" on the video and he will send you the link directly
 - No upfront cost mentioned for the trial period